Invest SA

South Australia
The space state



invest.sa.gov.au

SOUTH AUSTRALIA

Government of South Australia

Invest SA is a dedicated team of investment business professionals within the Department of State Development (DSD) that can connect you with opportunities, industry networks and other government agencies in the South Australian space sector.

DSD's dedicated Space Team offers specialist industry and investment advice in partnership with the South Australian Space Industry Centre (SASIC) and Defence SA, to drive economic growth and support South Australian businesses.

SASIC provides a whole-of-state-government focal point, spearheading the advancement of space industry innovation, research and entrepreneurial development.

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Moon exploration
Image courtesy of the Australian Space Agency

Adelaide University
Formerly The University of Adelaide and University of South Australia

Australian Space Agency

DEFENCE AND SPACE LANDING PAD

Flinders University

Australian Government
Department of Defence
Defence Science and Technology Group

ICC INNOVATION & COLLABORATION CENTRE

Innovation Places South Australia

SOUTH AUSTRALIAN SPACE INDUSTRY CENTRE

SMARTSAT Cooperative Research Centre

SOUTH AUSTRALIA

Government of South Australia
Department of State Development

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South Australia's ability to support test, launch and return missions within the state offers a unique value proposition for investors seeking to capitalise on the rapidly growing commercial space economy, providing a centralised gateway for in-space manufacturing and logistics through localised launch and return services.

"We are seeing strong interest from around the world for the globally unique test ranges Southern Launch brings to the market."

Lloyd Damp
CEO, Southern Launch

Our strengths = your opportunity



South Australian Space Industry Centre

Supports space entrepreneurs, provides an incubator for space projects and has built an environment where new space technologies can be rapidly developed.



Australian Space Agency

Delivering the best outcomes across national and civil space priority areas for the Australian space sector at Lot Fourteen.



Home to over 100 Space organisations

Featuring private enterprises including Fleet Space Technologies, entX Limited, Inovor Technologies, QuantX Labs, along with consultancies, associations, research organisations and academic institutions.



Commercial test, launch and return capability

Koonibba Test Range, Whalers Way Orbital Launch Complex and Woomera Range Complex are all located within South Australia and support orbital launch, sub-orbital missions, orbital re-entries and range services for defence and aerospace organisations.



Tonsley Innovation District

Brings together research, businesses, government and the wider community, 10 kilometres south of the Adelaide CBD.



Space Sector Strategy

South Australia was the first Australian state to develop a space strategy to drive innovation, research and development.



Lot Fourteen

Innovation precinct, home to the Australian Space Agency, Defence and Space Landing Pad recipients, SmartSat Cooperation Research Centre and the Australian Space Discovery Centre.



Technology Park

A vibrant world-class business community of innovative, hi-tech organisations with a strong focus on systems development and integration, information communication technology, advanced manufacturing and electronics. Businesses located there include SAAB Australia.

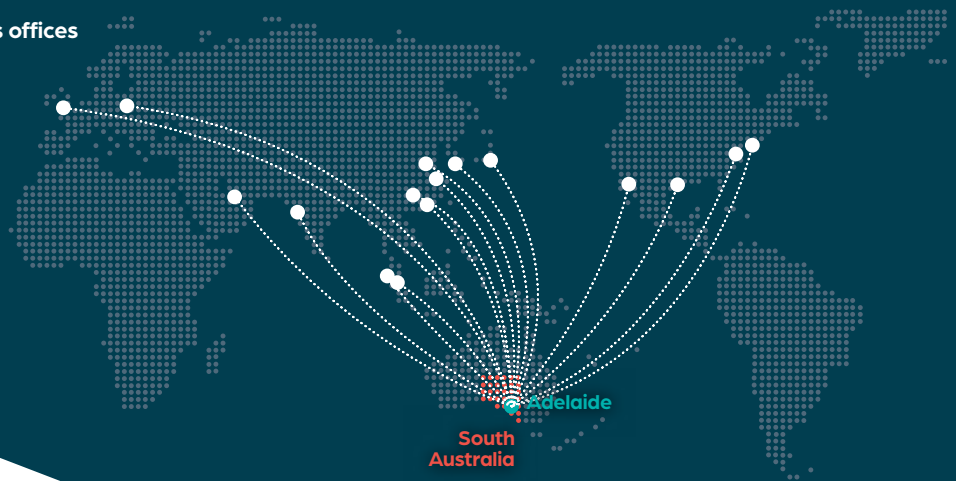
"South Australia's ecosystem of innovation, talent development, and commitment to the space industry has been an important part of Fleet Space's exponential growth. It's an environment that has enabled us to flourish on our mission to build a more sustainable path to net-zero by pushing the boundaries of space innovation. We're proud to be a part of this dynamic community."

Flavia Tata Nardini
Co-founder and CEO, Fleet Space Technologies

Introducing South Australia

Ecosystem	Innovative space ecosystem including South Australian Space Industry Centre (SASIC) and the Australian Space Agency (ASA). Over 100 space organisations delivering innovation in both upstream and downstream segments, supported by a progressive defence, life sciences, cyber and advance manufacturing ecosystems. Over a hundred companies thrive within a network of primes, small to medium enterprises and startup companies across advanced manufacturing and aerospace domains.
Research, innovation and education	World-renowned universities combined with national research centres such as the SmartSat Cooperative Research Centre, Lot Fourteen and Tonsley Innovation District. Leading catalyst and incubator programs for startup companies.
Focused government investment and critical Infrastructure	Major upgrades and maintenance scheduled for key infrastructure across the state, including new space manufacturing capability, with plans underway to establish a common user space assembly, test and integration facility at Lot Fourteen. Competitive construction costs for new infrastructure. Affordable land linked to transport corridors and key infrastructure for new projects including test and evaluation areas.
Test, launch and return	South Australia is the only place in the world that has commercial returns to land. Spaceports located at the Koonibba and Woomera Test Ranges and the Whalers Way Orbital Launch Complex. Unique geographical position enabling polar and sun-synchronous launch and return services.
Workforce and capability	Industry contributing products and services into global and local supply chains for the build and sustainment of space projects. Focus on Industry 4.0 technology development in key innovation places such as Lot Fourteen, Tonsley Innovation District and Technology Park Adelaide. Government and industry investment in a highly skilled workforce in line with the strategies including *South Australian Defence Industry Workforce and Skills Action Plan.*

● Invest SA overseas offices



What South Australia offers to investors

Invest SA helps facilitate:

- Identifying a suitable location
- Connections across government for approvals
- Attracting and retaining highly-skilled staff
- Introductions to industry partners and networking opportunities
- Planning and cross-government delivery of investment projects
- Connections with our global teams and identifying export opportunities

Collaborative ecosystem

South Australia's exceptionally connected space ecosystem includes companies that operate in almost all stages of the supply chain, with primes working alongside startups and small to medium enterprises (SMEs), to deliver best-in-class products and outcomes for industry.

Our space sector is prioritising the innovation and research in both upstream and downstream space.

SPACE INNOVATION

World class universities

Adelaide University
Formerly The University of Adelaide and University of South Australia

Flinders University

Government

South Australian Space Industry Centre

Australian Space Agency

Government of South Australia

Innovation and research precincts

Innovation Places South Australia

Technology Park Adelaide

Adelaide BioMed City

Tonsley Innovation District

Australian Government Department of Defence Defence Science and Technology Group

LOT_FOUR TEEN

Initiatives and projects

The Andy Thomas Space Foundation

AURORA

Australian Cyber Collaboration Centre

ICC Innovation & Collaboration Centre

STaR Shots

AustCyber Australian Cyber Security Growth Network

SMARTSAT Cooperative Research Centre

STONE & CHALK

DEFENCE INNOVATION PARTNERSHIP

UPSTREAM SPACE

Launch capabilities

ATSPACE

ela

SOUTHERN LAUNCH

AIR FORCE Woomera Range Complex

Satellites and spacecraft

NEUMANN SPACE

HEX20

AICRAFT

SPACE MACHINES COMPANY

FLEET

SURREY

ALAUDA

SABER ASTRONAUTICS

INOVOR TECHNOLOGIES

SPACE

Myriota

Integrated systems

LEONARDO

LOCKHEED MARTIN Australia

SAAB AUSTRALIA

ADVANCED MANUFACTURING AND SENSING

Silanna
DEWC SERVICES
QUANTX LABS
ResearchSat
Space Machines Company
HENSOLDT Detect and Protect.
AML3D
ARROW
APCA Technology
AXIOM Precision Manufacturing
Silentium Defence See Without Being Seen
toolcraft
REDARC
AEROBOND

DOWNSTREAM SPACE

Earth station and comms

Lockheed Martin Australia
LEAFSPACE
Nova Systems
Singtel
OPTUS
speedcast

Earth observations

aerometrex
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
LEO LABS
Digital Earth AUSTRALIA
tern Ecosystem Research Infrastructure
SSSI SA
THE UNIVERSITY of ADELAIDE
esri
UPG
CSIRO

Engineering and software

CGI
Capgemini
Nova Systems
DASSAULT SYSTEMES
SYPAQ
SHOAL

Big data, AI, cyber and quantum

aws
DeepMind
NEC
Myriota
Australian Institute for Machine Learning
FIVECAST
SAGE Automation
Aurizn
FLEET
OP SYS
CYBER OPS
De Stefano & Co Defence Industry Experts
DCAT
Deloitte.



South Australia – the space state

With over 100 space organisations across the state, South Australia has a dynamic space ecosystem that includes notable private investors, companies, startups, and research institutions that are developing space technologies and attracting global attention and investment.

The Australian Space Agency (ASA), the heart of the nation's space sector is located in South Australia. ASA's vision is to grow a globally respected space sector that lifts the Australian economy, inspires and improves the lives of Australians, and contributes to humanity's broader goals of exploration and a better Earth.

The SmartSat Cooperative Research Centre, headquartered in Adelaide, is Australia's leading space research consortium. It brings together Australian Government, state government and industry partners from around Australia and the world with a focus on advanced satellite systems, communication technologies and next generation earth observation data services.

The South Australian Space Industry Centre (SASIC), lead the Venture Catalyst Space program which is Australia's first space dedicated accelerator and incubator program of its kind. The program, delivered through the University of South Australia's Innovation and Collaboration Centre (ICC), supports the founders of new startups within the space sector.

Kanyini Mission – an Australian first

In 2024, the South Australian Government partnered with SmartSat Cooperative Research Centre and local companies Inovor Technologies and Myriota to send a locally manufactured small satellite to low Earth orbit.

Fully manufactured at Adelaide's Lot Fourteen innovation district, South Australia's first state-funded satellite - Kanyini - is a major milestone for South Australia's space sector. The mission has established space heritage for its South Australian partners, increased the capabilities of local space companies in the small satellite supply chain and created new investment opportunities for local space SMEs.

"The space sector in South Australia is thriving and is well-supported by the Government of South Australia and a range of other organisations."

Lloyd Lopez
CEO, Hex 20

With a strong foundation in advanced technologies and strategic geographic advantages for space flight, including returns, South Australia's space industry boasts a dynamic and comprehensive full-service ecosystem supported by leading research institutions and a thriving start-up culture.

Upstream

South Australia has established itself as a leader in the upstream space sector, boasting advanced facilities and highly skilled professionals with significant expertise in satellite manufacturing, launch services, and sophisticated tracking and communication systems.

- Advanced manufacturing, including spacecraft, sensors and components
- Spacecraft integration, testing and validation
- Launch services with full mission planning
- Payload development and integration
- Propulsion systems
- Space robotics and automation

Downstream

Through cutting-edge innovation districts and robust industry support, South Australia's downstream space sector leads globally through a collaborative ecosystem where shared expertise and resources deliver impactful solutions.

- Satellite operations and ground services
- Mission control and space operations
- Space Domain Awareness (SDA)
- Remote communications
- Data Services and Internet of Things (IoT)
- Connectivity and data added-value services
- Quantum-enabled position, navigation and timing

World's first commercial spaceport

South Australia's Koonibba Test Range is pioneering commercial space. The world's first commercial spaceport supports test, launch and re-entry operations.

Developed in partnership with Southern Launch and the Koonibba Community Aboriginal Corporation, this world-class space facility spans over 41,000 square kilometres of uninhabited land. It is one of the largest overland suborbital rocket testing facilities in the Southern Hemisphere.

In 2025, in a mission led by United States-based Varda Space Industries, Koonibba Test Range hosted the world's first-ever successful re-entry of a commercial spacecraft to a commercial spaceport.

This landmark achievement places South Australia at the forefront of the nation's launch and returns ecosystem.

Space manufacturing capability

The government has committed A$20 million to establish a space manufacturing facility within Lot Fourteen innovation district in Adelaide. This facility will provide industry access to world-class equipment for small satellite and component manufacturing, assembly, integration and testing.

Transformative frameworks

In July 2024, the Technology Safeguards Agreement (TSA) between Australia and the United States entered into force. This milestone agreement provides the legal and regulatory foundation for United States' entities to conduct spaceflight activities involving sensitive technologies from Australian territory.*

The TSA safeguards critical United States space technology while unlocking access to the United States launch market and supporting Australia's emergence as a global launch hub.

Alongside, South Australia's leading launch infrastructure and capabilities, this unprecedented signal of confidence for United States–based space projects to incorporate Australian businesses in space activities, will likely result in rapid growth across the sector.

**https://www.space.gov.au/technology-safeguards-agreement*



Committed government support

"From the very inception of the Inovor journey, the South Australian Government has been a pillar of strength, offering invaluable resources, financial assistance, and a conducive environment for innovation. Their commitment to fostering a thriving space industry in South Australia is truly commendable and has been instrumental in the growth and success of our business and our mission to push the boundaries of space technology.

The South Australian Government's efforts to create a collaborative ecosystem have been vital. By facilitating connections with other industry players, research institutions, and potential clients, they have helped us build robust networks that are essential for our business expansion and technological advancements."

Dr. Matt Tetlow
CEO and Founder, Inovor Technologies

Responsive Space Operations Centre
Image courtesy of Saber Astronautics

Delivering innovation

South Australia's experienced and collaborative research sector partners with industry leaders, and is supported by the Government of South Australia; creating a supportive ecosystem that delivers innovation and attracts local and international talent to the state.

Kanyini Mission

In 2024 the South Australian Government partnered with the SmartSat CRC and local companies Inovor Technologies and Myriota to send a locally manufactured small satellite to low Earth orbit (LEO) — the first Australian state government to ever embark on such a mission.

Boosting South Australia's space economy, the A$6.5 million Kanyini Mission strengthened the competitiveness of South Australian businesses in the small-satellite supply chain and pave the way for external investment and future growth in Australia and abroad.

Defence Science and Technology Group

Defence Science and Technology Group (DSTG) is the lead government agency responsible for applying science and technology to safeguard Australia and its national interests.

With its largest concentration of DSTG staff located in South Australia, the state offers unparalleled access to expertise, faster collaboration cycles, and a direct pathway from research to capability.

Defence Innovation Partnership

The Defence Innovation Partnership is a collaborative initiative of Defence SA, DSTG and South Australia's three public universities, the University of Adelaide, Flinders University and University of South Australia.

Bringing together a world-class collective of thinkers, practitioners and experts in defence research and development, each of the partners is committed to a model of genuine collaboration between governments, industries and universities.

SmartSat Cooperative Research Centre

Headquartered in Adelaide, the SmartSat CRC is Australia's leading space research centre.

Funded by the Australian Government's CRC Program, SmartSat CRC supports the development of technologies and know-how in advanced telecommunications, Artificial Intelligence, intelligent satellite systems and Earth observation data services.

The organisation brings together academic researchers, industry and end users to develop, manage and deliver useful technologies, algorithms and knowledge that supports every sector of the economy. The research and innovation developed creates the expertise to grow the Australian space industry, delivers economic prosperity and generates new high-tech jobs for future space leaders.

Andy Thomas Centre for Space Resources: EXTERRES Laboratory

The Extraterrestrial Environmental Simulation (EXTERRES) laboratory in the University of Adelaide is a state-of-the-art facility specifically designed to simulate off-Earth environments.

This world-class laboratory provides researchers and industry with a range of services that support the design, testing and development of technologies and processes destined for the lunar and Martian surface. It includes two rover testing pits, two Regolith Thermal Vacuum Chambers (RTVACs) and a regolith processing zone.

Ongoing development will make this the most complete off-world regolith simulant library available in the southern hemisphere.

Australian Government announced investment over the coming decade

The Australian Government is investing in the future security of the nation's defence, space and cyber capabilities.[1]

A$32 billion overall

[1] *Source: 2024 Integrated Investment Program. Note: All figures represented are in Australian Dollars*

Satellite communications

A sovereign-owned Australian defence satellite communications system to be introduced including communications satellites with ground stations and operations centres across Australia

Space domain

A$9-$12 billion will go towards resilient communications, surveillance and reconnaissance improved space awareness and control deep-space advanced radar system, for detection, tracking and identification of objects in deep space

Cyber domain

A$15-$20 billion for the ADF's warfighting networks in the cyber domain defensive and offensive capabilities to fight malicious activity

REDSPICE

Australian Signals Directorate's REDSPICE (Resilience – Effects – Defence – SPace – Intelligence – Cyber – Enablers) program funding prioritised to enhance cyber capabilities

Global advantage for launch and return

South Australia offers a globally unique opportunity: test, launch and return capabilities in the same state; environmental and operational advantages; and an ecosystem that supports industry innovation. The state's vast geography, coupled with robust infrastructure and regulatory readiness, enables safe, controlled and repeatable space operations from test to launch to recovery.

The state's unique geography and ongoing investment in infrastructure is meeting the growing international demand for easy, safe and reliable access commercial space ports. Key environmental and operational advantages include:

- **minimal air traffic and electromagnetic interference:** the testing and launching locations are outside significant flight paths reducing cost and risks during launch and re-entry
- **year-round accessibility:** moderate and predictable weather conditions allow for consistent scheduling and reduced delays, enhancing operational efficiency
- **large and versatile operational areas:** secure facilities that support a wide variety of mission profiles, including high-risk and experimental payloads

From launch vehicle development testing to microgravity experimentation and hypersonic flight, the Koonibba Test Range and Whalers Way Orbital Launch Complex can support test, evaluations, launch and return missions.

South Australia's growing influence in space landing capabilities is highlighted by key initiatives including the world's first successful re-entry of a commercial spacecraft to a commercial spaceport at the Koonibba Test Range.

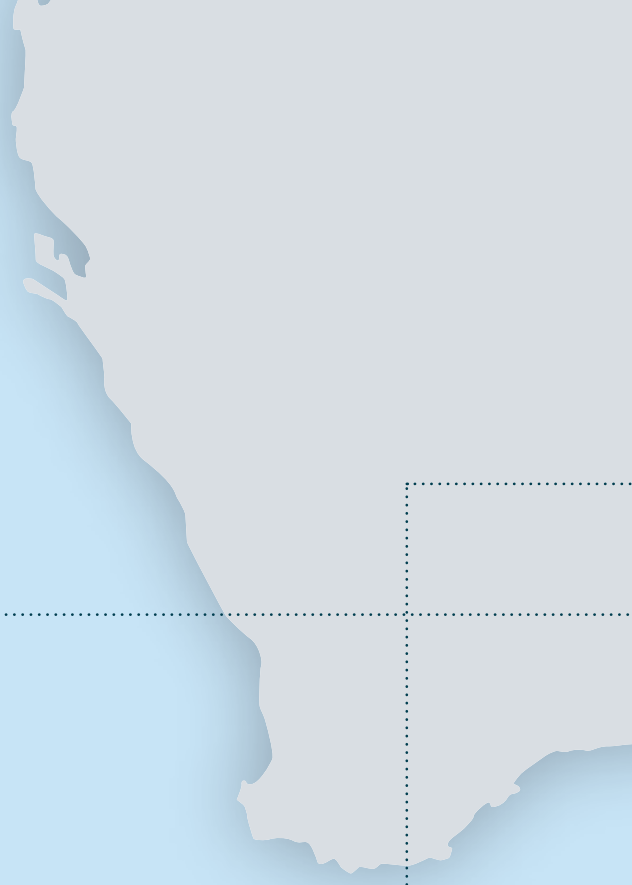
World first commercial return

Southern Launch's Koonibba Test Range successfully facilitated the re-entry of Varda Space Industries' Winnebago-2 (W-2) capsule in early 2025, carrying payloads for in-orbit pharmaceutical processing in microgravity. The successful re-entry and landing of the W-2 capsule marks not only the first commercial return on Australian soil, but also the first commercial return to a commercial spaceport anywhere in the world.

The successful re-entry and landing of the W-2 capsule is pivotal proof of South Australia's capability to the international space community, offering a fully equipped, commercial spaceport featuring advanced telemetry, radar and imaging systems and to leverage the geographic advantages of our expansive continent.



Access to test and evaluation, launch and return facilities



1

Koonibba Test Range

The Koonibba Test Range is one of the world's largest commercial ranges and Australia's largest civilian overland testing facility. It specialises in suborbital launches and returns from space.

The range is equipped with a 16.8 metre launch rail capable of launching rockets up to 4,200kg. The facility can also receive the return of space technology from orbit inclinations from polar orbit to as low as 32 degrees.

The Koonibba Test Range also offers:

- up to 41,000 square kilometres (15,830 square miles) of range area
- Up to 350km (217 miles) downrange
- Overland payload recovery
- Support from the logistics hub of Ceduna

The Koonibba Test Range is operated by Southern Launch in partnership with the Koonibba Community Aboriginal Corporation and is Australia's first licensed space launch facility.

Koonibba exemplifies inclusive, future-focused infrastructure—where cutting-edge aerospace technology meets Indigenous stewardship and international collaboration.

2

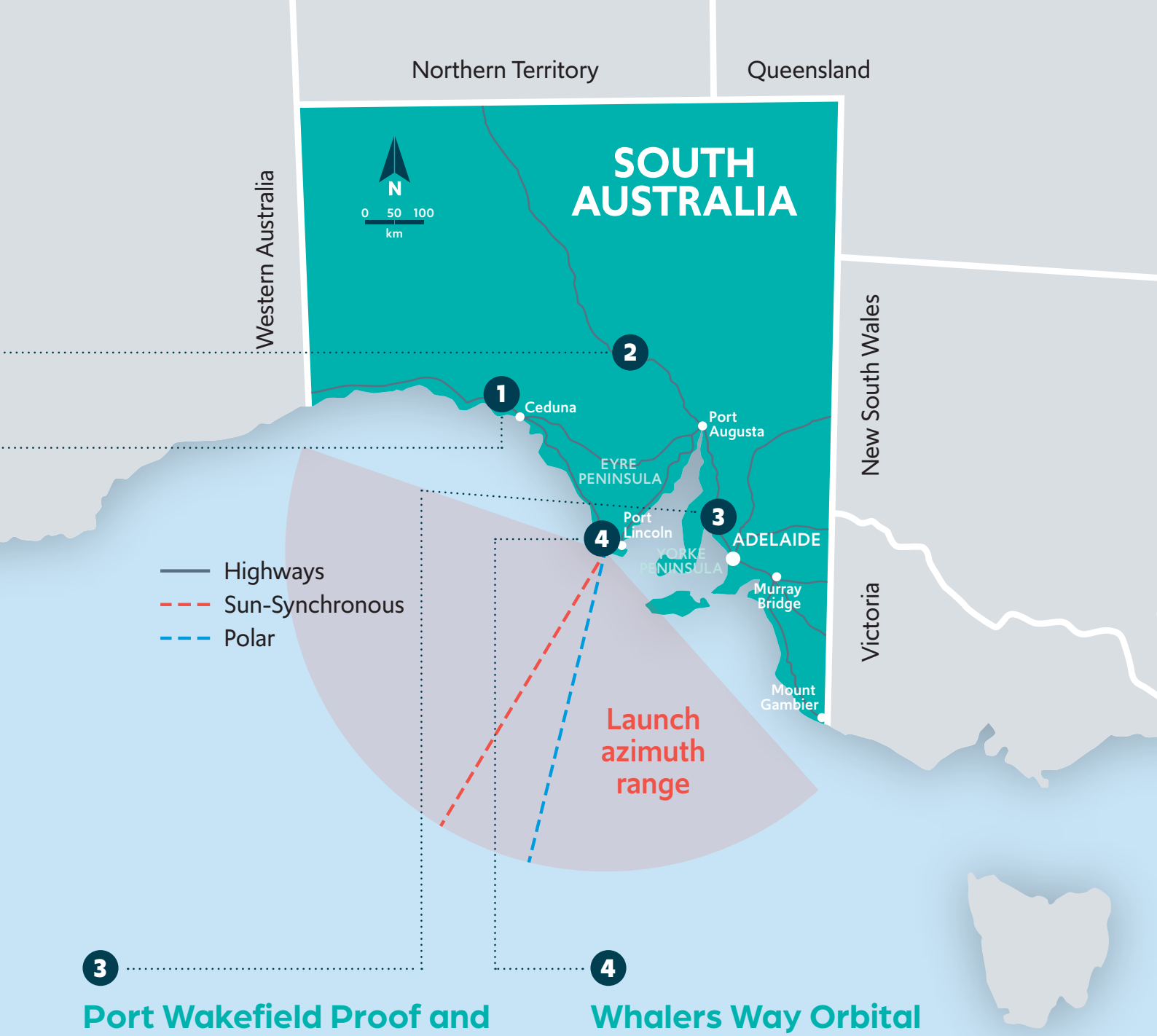
Woomera Range Complex

Largest land-based range in the western world, capable of testing rockets and hypersonic technology.

Size: 122,000 square kilometres

Location: 500 kms north-west of Adelaide

The Woomera Range Complex's remoteness and quiet electromagnetic environment is ideal for complex air, ground and space test activities. The Complex comprises the Woomera Test Range, RAAF Base Woomera and the Nurrungar Test Range.



3

Port Wakefield Proof and Experimental Establishment

Hosts rocket trials, munitions proofing and environmental testing for the Australian Defence Force.

Size: 56 square kilometres

Location: 83 kilometres north of Adelaide

Port Wakefield Proof and Experimental Establishment is the only range in Australia where projectiles can be fired into a coastal area and retrieved relatively undamaged for assessment.

4

Whalers Way Orbital Launch Complex

The Whalers Way Orbital Launch Complex is one of the only sites in the world that can provide high-cadence launches to polar and sun-synchronous orbits. It is a fully instrumented range with telemetry, optical and radar systems.

The Whalers Way Orbital Launch Complex supports direct ascent trajectories from 55 to 177 degrees including polar, sun-synchronous orbits and 135 degree (equivalent to 45 degree) inclination.

The complex covers over 16 square kilometres (6 square miles) of open land with over 6 kilometres (3.72 miles) of ocean frontage and supports direct ascent to orbit flight trajectories over the Great Australian Bight, maximising spacecraft payload to orbit. The complex can also accommodate hypersonic flight testing and the return of space technology from orbit over water.

Favourable launch conditions at the Whalers Way Orbital Launch Complex offers greater launch window availability and launch schedule flexibility. Stable year-round weather and low maritime and air traffic provide unhindered access to space.

HyImpulse SR75 rocket lifts off from Southern Launch Koonibba Test Range
Image courtesy of Southern Launch

Education and workforce development

South Australia boasts a highly skilled and rapidly expanding workforce that is well-positioned to support the growth of the space industry. With over 100 space-related organisations and the presence of the Australian Space Agency in Adelaide, the state has become the national hub for space innovation by cultivating a robust talent pipeline to meet the evolving needs of the global space economy.

Leveraging the state's strong foundations as a first mover, South Australia is rapidly gaining global recognition as a new location for pioneering space innovation. With a strong foundation in critical, defence, space, cyber technologies and life sciences, the state is well placed to elevate investment opportunities in these sectors.

Science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) pathways across all levels of education, from primary school to tertiary, are being developed in the state. Strategies, including the South Australian Defence Industry Workforce and Skills Action Plan, are guiding the workforce and sovereign capabilities required to sustain the continued growth of the defence and space sector within the state over the next 10 years and beyond.

From 2026, the new Adelaide University, a merger of the University of Adelaide with the University of South Australia, will combine the research strengths of both universities, creating Australia's largest defence and space research university. Adelaide University will sit alongside Flinders University, home to Australia's largest group of space law and policy experts, as well as leading vocational education and training (VET) providers, the largest of which is TAFE SA, offering courses that build job-specific skills across a wide range of industries including the space sector.

Industry-led education programs, collaboration and investments in space projects between government, industry and educational partners have driven increasing student numbers in South Australia.

Educational partners are growing the capacity and breadth of space related courses, ensuring that South Australia will produce highly skilled and job ready candidates to meet demand.



"Saber Astronautics has found South Australia extremely accommodating as a space business. From the moment we were granted the Mission Control Centre grant from the Australian Government's Space Infrastructure Fund, our business scaled rapidly – Talent in SA was quick to be found, and Lot Fourteen has facilitated an enormous amount of collaboration with other space companies."

Andreas Antoniades
National Director, Saber Astronautics Australia



Australian Space Discovery Centre

An immersive experience, the Australia Space Discovery Centre (ASDC) showcases information, artefacts, equipment and inspiring stories of innovation to capture students' curiosity of all ages. The centre is a tool to inform and inspire students about the space sector, opening doors to further learning and potential careers in the industry.

International Space University

The University of South Australia, in partnerships with the International Space University (ISU) conduct The Southern Hemisphere Space Studies Program (SHSSP).

The SHSSP is an intensive program providing a multidisciplinary understanding of the key activities and areas of knowledge required by today's space professionals. The program is based on a unique international, intercultural and interdisciplinary learning experience for which the ISU is renowned and connects professionals with the international space sector.

Global Executive Master of Business Administration (Defence and Space)

With sophisticated technological innovation, globalisation and shifting power balances all changing the face of the defence and space industries, the Global Executive Master of Business Administration (Defence and Space) is designed to meet the workforce development needs of these rapidly expanding sectors. A unique collaboration with international defence and space experts, the 18-month program is delivered across three countries: Australia, the United Kingdom and the United States.

Hamilton Space Academy

A dynamic and innovative ongoing program for students beginning in years 7-10. The Space Academy empowers students to develop the passion, skills, knowledge and experience that will prepare them for university and further education linking to careers in the space industry.

Supporting growth in the space sector

South Australian businesses are supported by the Government of South Australia to set up and expand operations locally.[2] These include:

Defence and Space Landing Pad

The Defence and Space Landing Pad is a one-stop-shop supporting the relocation, setup and growth of national and international companies to South Australia.

Managed by Defence SA, the program provides affordable, short-term facilities at Lot Fourteen, the state's defence, space and critical technology innovation hub located in the Adelaide central business district, and provides companies with immediate connections and assistance to establish offices, research and/or manufacturing facilities and grow.

South Australian Space Collaboration and Innovation Fund

The fund supports the rapid transition of space technology into operational use while growing the South Australian space ecosystem.

The fund has backed projects that focus on proof-of-concept or delivery of space capability and have a clear commercial pathway. Since 2024, the fund has successfully completed two rounds, providing funding to three South Australian projects each in collaboration with an international partner.

Approved projects are to support the advancement of sovereign capabilities in space, grow the workforce and talent in the sector and drive innovative technology solutions. Outcomes will drive wider economic benefits across South Australia and open doors for the local space sector globally.

Australia's Space Concession program

The Space Concession program is an Australian Commonwealth program that supports companies wanting to develop technology for the space sector and encourages the transfer of technology and expertise by providing duty-free tariff on eligible imported goods.

An authorised space project must involve activities between parties from Australia and other countries that include joint investment, research, manufacturing or supply of equipment.



[2] *Subject to funding, eligibility and support requirements.*

Space innovation across industry

South Australia's space sector is complemented by the state's innovation and strengths across other industries. The unique and collaborative ecosystem supports the transfer of innovation across sectors, accelerating research and development, de-risking missions and opening new commercial pathways.

Space innovation powering mineral exploration

- **Fleet Space Technology** develops exploration technology leveraging seismic data and AI insights to scale mineral discovery. This creates effective imaging of geological features aiding mineral exploration through satellite-enabled, end-to-end exploration to depths of 2.5km. Fleet Space Technology is poised to become the first Australian seismic technology to land on the moon's surface.
- **The Andy Thomas Centre for Space Resources:** Extraterrestrial Environmental Simulation (EXTERRES) laboratory is a state-of-the-art facility supporting the test and development of experimental equipment and infrastructure for off-Earth environments for habitats and mining.

Our cyber advantage

Located in South Australia are two of the nation's leading cyber capabilities.

- **Australian Cyber Collaboration Centre** (Aus3C) is a central connection point for businesses looking to improve their cyber resilience. Aus3C connects leaders, thinkers and doers of today and tomorrow with real opportunities to learn, activate businesses, adapt to change and solve challenges within the digital domain.
- **Defence Science and Technology Group**-Cyber, Intelligence and National Security division. This division leads the delivery of innovation, science and technology programs for defence intelligence, joint capabilities and joint operations. The division focuses on:
  - national security
  - artificial intelligence
  - quantum
  - intelligence
  - cyber

South Australia: where collaboration can move your mission from idea to impact, faster.



Case studies

Plants for Space

The University of Adelaide-led Australian Research Council (ARC) Centre of Excellence in Plants for Space (P4S) is connecting South Australia's burgeoning space sector and world-class agricultural research, to deliver an international challenge of developing sustainable, self-sufficient plant growth systems for future space missions.

The Australian and UK Space Agencies are supporting three collaborative space projects with a range of benefits to life here on Earth. The selected projects include:

- Autonomous Agriculture for Space Exploration project,
- AI for Space Operations, Safety and Sustainability,
- Aquawatch UK (space-enabled water management).

The P4S initiative aims to develop a fully autonomous agriculture system to the world's first commercial space station, being constructed by United States company Axiom Space. The project supports efforts to enable humans to survive and thrive in space, and delivers direct benefits to the horticulture, food and bio-manufacturing sectors on Earth.

P4S is an A$90 million multi-disciplinary endeavour including plant science, space law, systems and process engineering, food chemistry, psychology and education. Established in January 2024, P4S is located in five foundational Australian universities including South Australia's University of Adelaide and Flinders University.

P4S is an international research consortium of more than 30 partners representing academia, government and industry, such as the South Australian-located Australian Space Agency and Saber Astronautics, as well as NASA, Axiom Space, Vertical Future, Space Lab Technologies, Yuri, University of Cambridge, University of California, Berkley and ETH Zurich.

P4S' broader vision to enable long duration space exploration and improve on-Earth sustainability, will be achieved through four core missions.

1. **Complete nutrition plant–based foods**
   'Complete nutrition' plants that humans could survive on for a year without sacrificing health.

2. **Zero–waste plants optimised for controlled environments**
   Fast-growing, zero-waste, 'pick & eat' plant varieties that exceed current on-Earth performance.

3. **On–demand bioresource production**
   On-demand or large-scale production of novel, recyclable biomolecules, including plant-based construction materials and pharmaceuticals, that can be processed with minimal energy, resources and waste.

4. **Future–ready workforce and society**
   Includes anticipatory and responsive legal, regulatory, ethical and psychological frameworks to determine and refine process design to facilitate successful outcomes; evidence-based training, leadership, and mentoring framework to inspire and equip staff, students, and stakeholders at scale; and co-design between academia, government, industry, and startups to provide major sector uplift.

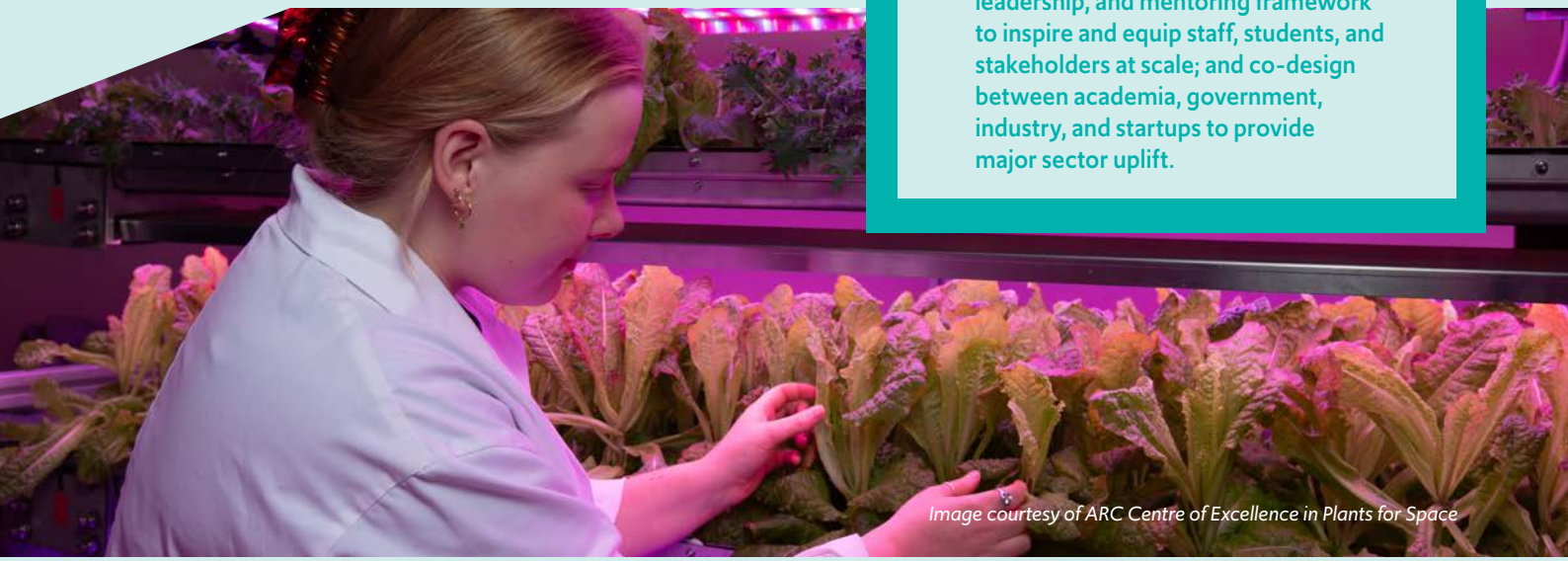


Image courtesy of ARC Centre of Excellence in Plants for Space



Lunar rover, Roo-ver
Image courtesy of the Australian Space Agency

Moon to Mars initiative

South Australia is a key partner for the Australian Government's Moon to Mars initiative supporting Australian businesses and researchers to join NASA's inspirational endeavour to go to the Moon and then to Mars.

Based in South Australia, the Australian Space Agency is a signatory to NASA's Artemis Accords which establish the principles, guidelines and best practices for civil space activity. The Agency oversees the initiative to accelerate the growth of Australia's space industry and showcase our best ideas and technologies to the world. Federal funding and grant opportunities align with this initiative, with the result seeing Australia advance its contribution to the global space economy, while also supporting NASA's Moon to Mars endeavours and future space missions.

Trailblazer program

The Trailblazer program is Australia's flagship mission supporting NASA's Moon to Mars activities that demonstrates and develops Australia's strengths, ingenuity and capabilities, while inspiring the nation.

The program provides an opportunity for the Australian space sector to design, build and execute a lunar exploration mission, while supporting NASA's endeavour to go forward to the Moon and on to Mars. This program will demonstrate Australia's key strengths in a complex lunar environment, growing the industry.

Roo-ver

An outcome from the Space Trailblazer Program, in partnership with the Australian Space Agency, 'Roo-ver' is a lunar rover, developed by two consortiums from a collaboration between universities, including the University of Adelaide and a range of private organisations across the space and defence sectors, most of which have a presence in South Australia.

Roo-ver will be part of an Artemis mission and is designed to explore the moon's surface, collecting lunar regolith (moon dirt) samples to be processed in a NASA facility to measure oxygen levels.

Innovation places

Government, research, business and industry co-locate across 21 innovation places state-wide, capitalising on proximity to talent, investment opportunities, skills and workforce programs.



Edinburgh Defence Precinct
34kms from CBD

Key national defence research, manufacturing and sustainment hub housing the RAAF Base Edinburgh, Defence Science and Technology Group and major defence companies.

Technology Park
17kms from CBD

Hub for systems development and integration, information communications technology, advanced manufacturing and electronics, and home to over 100 SMEs, multinationals and startups.

Lot Fourteen
Adelaide CBD

Lot Fourteen is a world-class innovation district with a curated, collaborative research and business ecosystem. Home to the Australian Space headquarters, SmartSat CRC, Defence and Space Landing Pad, Stone & Chalk startup Hub, Australian Institute for Machine Learning (AIML), Australian Cyber Collaboration Centre (Aus3C), Myriota, Inovor Technologies, Space Machines Company, Saber Astronautics and QuantX Labs.

Tonsley Innovation District
12kms from CBD

Home to high value manufacturing industries including defence, health, medical devices and assistive technologies, cleantech and renewable energy, software and simulation and mining and energy services.

Australia's most cost competitive city

South Australia's competitive business environment supports commercial success, a suitably skilled workforce with competitive labour costs and high staff retention rates.

With one of the lowest central business district office rental costs, establishing in Adelaide will support companies to operate and more rapidly scale their operations.

Most affordable CBD office rent (AUD/sqm p.a.)



Most affordable industrial rental space (AUD/sqm p.a.)



Adelaide offers an unrivalled cost advantage

Invest SA has prepared a generic cost model to demonstrate the cost savings over 10 years for 20 full time staff based in Adelaide compared to other major Australian capital cities. The model takes into account warehouse leasing costs, salary costs and payroll tax.

$17.6m
cost saving when compared to Sydney

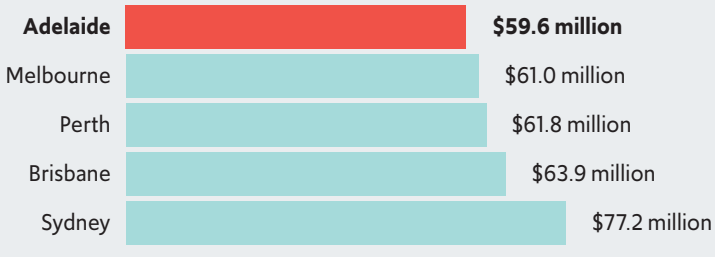
$4.3m
cost saving when compared to Brisbane

$2.2m
cost saving when compared to Perth

$1.4m
cost saving when compared to Melbourne

Cumulative operational costs over 10 years

Total operational costs over the next ten financial years



Assumptions

- *All costs are in current Australian Dollars (AUD).*
- *All payroll tax payments assume wages for Australian business operations only and do not consider pre-existing business operations.*
- *All property transfer duty and land tax calculations are estimates only. Companies may face different rates, exemptions, or additional charges depending on existing company operations, alternate land uses, leasing agreements etc.*
- *Staff salaries sourced from the Hays Salary Guide exclude superannuation and so is added on top of these estimates.*
- *Wages and salaries are assumed to increase by the state-respective Wage Price Index (WPI) each year.*
- *Land prices, site leasing costs, and construction costs are assumed to increase by the state-respective Producer Price Index (PPI) each year.*
- *Queensland's Regional Property Payroll Tax Concession ends on 30 June 2030.*
- *Victoria's Regional Property Tax Concession assumes at least 85 per cent of the business' operations occur outside of Greater Melbourne.*
- *Victoria's Temporary Payroll Tax Surcharge ends on 30 June 2033.*
- *The Federal Creative Industries Offset/Rebate is assumed to cap at $20 million.*

Advantage Adelaide – live, work & play

From the city to the sea, South Australia offers the ultimate living experience with something for everyone.

Our state is a prime living destination for young professionals and families alike, boasting a perfect combination of cultural experiences, picturesque landscapes, and a lively yet peaceful city centre, in a Mediterranean climate with warm, dry summers and mild winters.

Adelaide is a progressive, cosmopolitan capital offering a premium lifestyle with world-renowned festivals, major sporting events and iconic locations, such as the Barossa Valley, Kangaroo Island and Flinders Ranges.

South Australia's innovative, cost competitive and agile nature is luring more young talent, and the ability to rapidly scale and provide skilled workers in critical sectors has caught the attention of world-class companies.

With a thriving economy, recognition as one of Australia's safest cities, and consistent ranking as one of the world's most liveable cities by The Economist Intelligence Unit's Global Liveability Index, Adelaide offers a great lifestyle for individuals and families at an affordable cost.

Whether you choose city, suburban or country life, you are guaranteed a lifestyle that supports work-life balance, a supportive and family-friendly community and high- quality options for primary, high school and university students.

The high-quality education credentials of the state's private and public schools are showcased in the latest release of the Better Education analysis of 2024 academic outcomes. South Australia achieved top results, with every secondary school in the top 50 achieving at least 91 out of 100 points and three high schools attaining a maximum score.

South Australia's established role as Australia's Defence State has attracted large numbers of national and international employees, building a diverse defence community with social and professional networks that support workers and their families throughout their relocation journey.

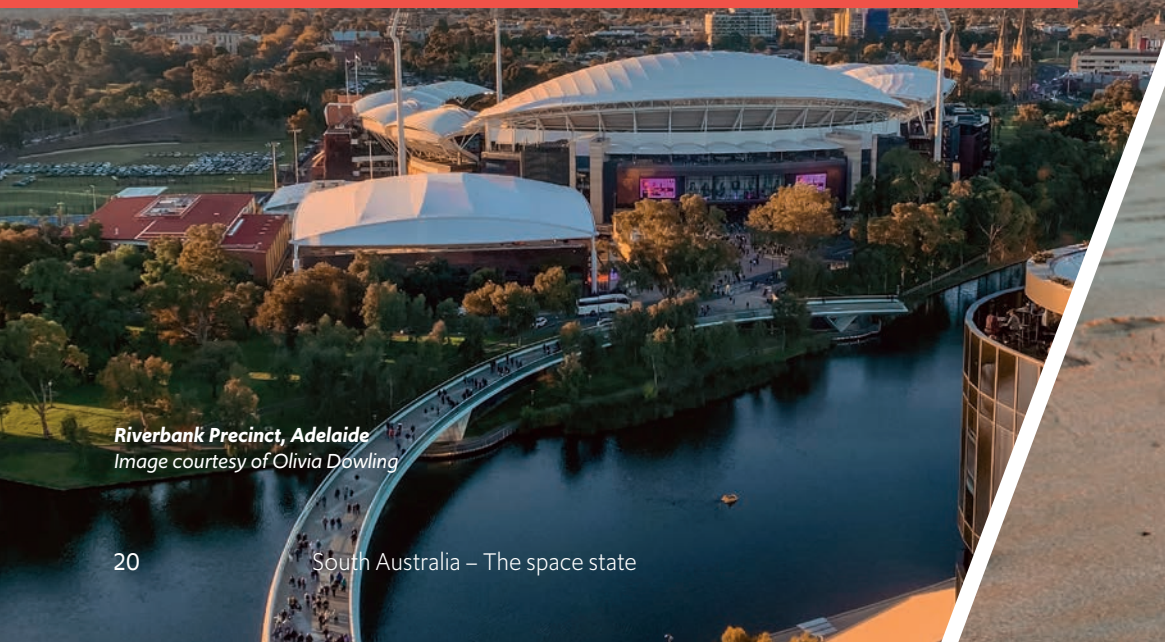


- **Australia's best location for doing business. South Australia's land planning system recognised as the nation's best, based on efficiency, consistency, certainty and transparency [4]**
- **One of the lowest cost of living capital cities in Australia [5]**
- **Adelaide's median house price is 40% lower than Sydney [6]**

[4] *Business Council of Australia, Regulation Rumble report 2023 and 2024*

[5] *Mercer: Cost of Living City Ranking 2024 – Sydney 58, Melbourne 73,Brisbane 89, Perth 109, Adelaide 107*

[6] *Australian Bureau of Statistics, December 2024*



Riverbank Precinct, Adelaide
Image courtesy of Olivia Dowling





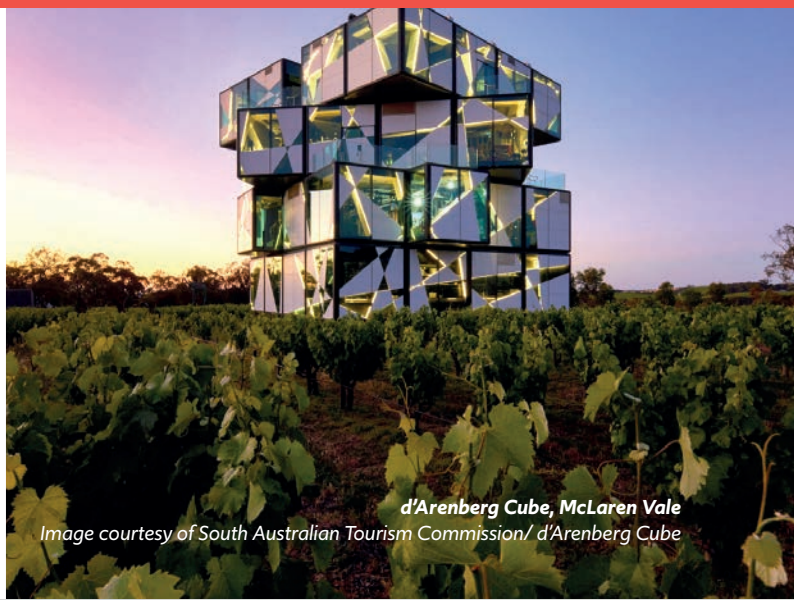
Barristers Block, Adelaide Hills
Image courtesy of South Australian Tourism Commission

"We came to South Australia because we believe it is a great city for our employees to enjoy a healthy and balanced lifestyle, raise their families, and still have access to world-class festivals and entertainment."

Rakesh Prabhakar
Regional Manager Australia/New Zealand, Zoho



WOMADelaide, Adelaide
Image courtesy of Grant Hancock



d'Arenberg Cube, McLaren Vale
Image courtesy of South Australian Tourism Commission/ d'Arenberg Cube



Ethel Beach, Dhilba Guuranda-Innes National Park
Image courtesy of Katey Wehrman

Let's talk

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SOUTH AUSTRALIA

Government of South Australia